

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Let's find out what it's like to be a ballplayer!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever spoken with a famous athlete? What did you say?
- If you could interview anyone in the sports world, who would you choose?

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use words like *accuracy* and *legitimacy*.
- I can use proper intonation and stress.
- I can accurately pronounce complete sentences.





Let's Explore!

An interview with a young **curmudgeon***.

* A "curmudgeon" is someone who is grumpy.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Reporter:** I'm here with legendary star Tip O'Neill. What are some things every baseball fan should know?
- Tip:** You have to develop a high baseball IQ. I mean, you have to have some literacy when it comes to the jargon.
- Reporter:** Got any examples?
- Tip:** Sure. If someone says we got a doubleheader, it means we're playing two games in one day. Or if someone says there's a southpaw pitching today, it means he's left-handed.
- Reporter:** Got it. So what's the best thing about baseball, in your opinion?
- Tip:** The best thing about baseball is that it's a meritocracy. You can't fake the stats. If you get a hit 30% of the time, you're a star. If you get a hit 25% of the time, you're a bum. And they can measure this stuff with high levels of accuracy.
- Reporter:** Sounds like you're talking about the modern day batting statistics.
- Tip:** Exactly. It gives everything we do a legitimacy, because we can measure our value in so many different ways.
- Reporter:** How have things changed in the game?
- Tip:** Well you know baseball didn't allow minorities to play for a long time, so that was a huge black mark on the game. It took a lot of advocacy to change people's attitudes. Especially the old-fashioned owners.
- Reporter:** Must have changed in a number of smaller ways as well, I imagine.
- Tip:** Yeah. Chewing tobacco used to be considered a delicacy in the dugout. Now it's frowned upon due to the health risks.
- Reporter:** So it was the power of the people. A real democracy.
- Tip:** Baseball is not a democracy. The manager is in charge, and he's usually a bad-tempered old curmudgeon.
- Reporter:** Ever thought about managing?
- Tip:** Of course, I have to think about my legacy. Wait, are you calling me a bad-tempered old curmudgeon?
- Reporter:** Not at all, you're more of a bad-tempered young curmudgeon.





Let's Practice!

Let's listen some pieces of O'Neill's interview.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm here with legendary star Tip O'Neill. What are some things every baseball fan should know?
2. Sure. If someone says we got a doubleheader, it means we're playing two games in one day.
3. And they can measure this stuff with high levels of accuracy.
4. Especially the old-fashioned owners.
5. The manager is in charge, and he's usually a bad-tempered old curmudgeon.



Let's Practice!

Athletes talk about their work!

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to complete the sentences. There are two words that you don't need to use.

Word Bank

• accuracy • meritocracy • delicate • delicacy • legacy • accurate • legitimacy

1. The best thing about baseball is that it's a _____.
2. It gives everything we do a _____.
3. Chewing tobacco used to be considered a _____ in the dugout.
4. Of course, I have to think about my _____.
5. And they can measure this stuff with high levels of _____.





Extension Activity

Create a mock interview.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose your favorite athlete.
- Create a list of twenty questions to ask.
- Have a partner read the questions to you.
Invent the answers yourself.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research an athlete.

☐ ☐

I create questions that could be used in an interview.

☐ ☐

I respond to interview questions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **literacy** (noun): the ability to read and write
e.g. I mean, you have to have some literacy when it comes to the jargon.
- **doubleheader** (noun): when two (usually sporting) events are held in the same day
e.g. If someone says we got a doubleheader, it means we're playing two games in one day.
- **southpaw** (noun): a person who is left-handed
e.g. Or if someone says there's a southpaw pitching today, it means he's left-handed.
- **meritocracy** (noun): a place where everyone is judged on merit and ability
e.g. The best thing about baseball is that it's a meritocracy. You can't fake the stats.
- **accuracy** (noun): precision
e.g. They can measure this stuff with high levels of accuracy.
- **legitimacy** (noun): the quality of being legal or verified
e.g. It gives everything we do a legitimacy, because we can measure our value in so many different ways.
- **advocacy** (noun): public support of an idea
e.g. It took a lot of advocacy to change people's attitudes.
- **delicacy** (noun): a delicious food, usually one that is uncommon and expensive
e.g. Chewing tobacco used to be considered a delicacy in the dugout.
- **dugout** (noun): a shelter, usually located partially underground, for members of a sports team
e.g. The visiting team was assigned the eastern dugout.
- **legacy** (noun): what a person leaves behind after moving on or passing away
e.g. Of course, I have to think about my legacy.





Learning Points

Stressing Two Syllables Back From the Suffix: -cy

When you say words that end with the suffix **-cy**, you stress the third-from-last syllable from the end of the word, or two syllables before the **-cy** ending.

Read these words out loud. Concentrate on the pronunciation. Stress the third-from-last syllable.

dem**o**cracy

leg**a**cy

merit**o**cracy

hyp**o**crisy

Examples:

- *Of course, I have to think about my legacy.*
- *The best thing about baseball is that it's a meritocracy.*





Learning Points

Stress for Nouns and Adjectives

You stress nouns and adjectives in a sentence to add meaning or emphasis to a statement or a message.

In English, 2-syllable adjectives or words usually have stress on the first syllable.

Example: **awesome**, **present**, **clever**, **football**, **baseball**

For compound nouns, the stress is on the first part of the noun.

Example: **greenhouse**, **basketball**, **volleyball**

For compound adjectives, the stress is on the second part of the noun.

Example: *old-**fashioned***, *bad-**tempered***

When you use an adjective to describe a noun, you normally emphasize the noun if you are not stressing the quality of the noun.

Example:

*I drive a red **car**.*

When you want to emphasize the quality of that noun, you stress the adjective that describes it.

Example:

*Look at that **red** car over there!*

When you have several adjectives describing a noun, you stress the quality that you are focusing on the most.

Example:

*I'm driving a brand new red **Japanese** car.*

Examples:

- *I'm here with **legendary** star Tip O'Neill.*
- *Not at all, you're more of a **bad-tempered** young curmudgeon.*
- *What are some things every **baseball** fan should know?*

